

Fynla — Development Cost Estimate

Analysis Date: 6 March 2026 **Codebase Version:** v0.8.3 **Project Start:** 14 October 2025 | **Latest Commit:** 5 March 2026

Codebase Metrics

Category	Files	Lines of Code
PHP — Application (app/)	496	113,464
└─ Services (business logic)	174	68,477
└─ Controllers (API layer)	70	21,896
└─ Models	77	8,514
└─ Agents (orchestrators)	8	3,258
└─ Requests (validation)	70	4,291
└─ Resources, Traits, Middleware, etc.	97	7,028
Vue Components	439	154,749
JavaScript (stores, services, utils, router)	81	21,867
└─ Vuex Stores	21	9,078
└─ API Services	34	4,912
└─ Utils, Mixins, Router	—	1,991
Tests (Pest/PHPUnit)	120	32,696
Database (migrations, seeders, factories)	168	13,535
└─ Migrations	108	4,721
└─ Seeders	16	5,323
└─ Factories	44	3,491
Routes & Config	—	2,796
CSS	—	434
TOTAL	1,304	339,542

Complexity Factors

- **7 financial modules** (Protection, Savings, Investment, Retirement, Estate, Goals, Coordination) — each with its own agent, services, controllers, Vue components, and Vuex store

- **UK tax compliance:** IHT, CGT, income tax bands, pension allowances, ISA limits — all from TaxConfigService, not hardcoded
- **Joint ownership model:** Single-record joint assets with calculated ownership shares
- **Monte Carlo simulations:** Stochastic financial projections
- **Actuarial life tables:** Mortality-based planning calculations
- **Payment integration:** Revolut SDK (CDN-based) with webhook processing
- **Preview mode system:** 6 seeded personas with full data isolation + write interception middleware
- **Auth system:** Sanctum-based with 2FA verification codes
- **Design system:** Custom 6-colour palette with strict governance ([fynlaDesignGuide.md](#) v1.2.0)

Development Time Estimate

Base Development Hours (by code category)

Code Category	Lines	Productivity Rate	Hours
Services (complex financial logic)	68,477	15 lines/hr	4,565
Controllers (API layer)	21,896	25 lines/hr	876
Models, Traits, Observers	9,950	25 lines/hr	398
Agents (orchestration logic)	3,258	15 lines/hr	217
Requests, Resources, Middleware	6,016	30 lines/hr	201
Constants, Config, Routes	3,224	30 lines/hr	107
Vue Components (UI + logic)	154,749	15 lines/hr	10,317
JavaScript (stores, services)	21,867	20 lines/hr	1,093
Database (migrations, seeders, factories)	13,535	12 lines/hr	1,128
Tests	32,696	30 lines/hr	1,090
CSS	434	25 lines/hr	17
Subtotal Base Coding	335,668		20,009 hrs

Overhead Multipliers

Factor	%	Hours
Architecture & Design	+18%	3,602
Debugging & Troubleshooting	+28%	5,603
Code Review & Refactoring	+12%	2,401
Documentation	+10%	2,001
Integration & Testing	+22%	4,402
UK Tax/Financial Domain Learning	+15%	3,001

Total Estimated Development Hours: ~41,019 hours

Realistic Calendar Time (with Organisational Overhead)

Company Type	Efficiency	Coding Hrs/Week	Calendar Weeks	Calendar Time
Solo/Startup (lean)	65%	26 hrs	1,578 wks	~30 years
Growth Company	55%	22 hrs	1,864 wks	~36 years
Enterprise	45%	18 hrs	2,279 wks	~44 years
Large Bureaucracy	35%	14 hrs	2,930 wks	~56 years

Note: These are single-developer estimates. A team of 4-6 would divide calendar time proportionally (with ~20% coordination overhead).

Team Size	Lean Startup	Growth Co	Enterprise
1 dev	30.3 years	35.8 years	43.8 years
3 devs	12.1 years	14.3 years	17.5 years
5 devs	7.9 years	9.3 years	11.4 years
8 devs	5.5 years	6.5 years	7.9 years

Market Rate Research

Senior Full-Stack Developer Rates (2025–2026)

Market	Hourly Rate
UK Senior (London)	£75–£110/hr
US Remote/Mid-Market	\$80–\$100/hr
US Standard	\$100–\$130/hr
US Premium (NYC/SF)	\$130–\$150/hr
Senior Laravel+Vue specialist	\$75–\$120/hr

Recommended Rate for This Project: \$100/hr (£80/hr)

Rationale: This project requires deep UK tax domain knowledge, financial calculation expertise, actuarial modelling, payment integration, and full-stack Laravel+Vue.js proficiency. This commands mid-to-high rates.

Total Cost Estimate (Engineering Only)

Scenario	Hourly Rate	Total Hours	Total Cost
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Scenario	Hourly Rate	Total Hours	Total Cost
Low-end	\$80/hr	41,019	\$3,281,520
Average	\$100/hr	41,019	\$4,101,900
High-end	\$140/hr	41,019	\$5,742,660

Recommended Engineering Estimate: \$3.3M – \$4.1M

Full Team Cost (All Roles)

Role Breakdown (Growth Company)

Role	Ratio	Hours	Rate	Cost
Engineering	1.00x	41,019 hrs	\$100/hr	\$4,101,900
Product Management	0.30x	12,306 hrs	\$175/hr	\$2,153,550
UX/UI Design	0.25x	10,255 hrs	\$150/hr	\$1,538,250
Engineering Management	0.15x	6,153 hrs	\$200/hr	\$1,230,600
QA/Testing	0.20x	8,204 hrs	\$110/hr	\$902,440
Project Management	0.10x	4,102 hrs	\$130/hr	\$533,260
Technical Writing	0.05x	2,051 hrs	\$100/hr	\$205,100
DevOps/Platform	0.15x	6,153 hrs	\$175/hr	\$1,076,775
TOTAL		90,243 hrs		\$11,741,875

Full Team Cost by Company Stage

Company Stage	Multiplier	Full Team Cost
Solo/Founder	1.0x	\$4,101,900
Lean Startup	1.45x	\$5,947,755
Growth Company	2.2x	\$9,024,180
Enterprise	2.65x	\$10,870,035

Grand Total Summary

Metric	Solo	Lean Startup	Growth Co	Enterprise
Calendar Time (5 devs)	6.1 yrs	7.9 yrs	9.3 yrs	11.4 yrs
Total Human Hours	41,019	59,478	90,243	108,700
Total Cost	\$4.1M	\$5.9M	\$9.0M	\$10.9M

Claude ROI Analysis

Project Timeline

- First commit: 14 October 2025
- Latest commit: 5 March 2026
- Total calendar time: 141 days (~4.7 months)
- Total commits: 1,119

Claude Active Hours Estimate

- Total sessions identified: 131 sessions
- Estimated active hours: **304 hours**
- Method: Git commit clustering (4-hour gap = new session)

Value per Claude Hour

Value Basis	Total Value	Claude Hours	\$/Claude Hour
Engineering only (avg)	\$4,101,900	304 hrs	\$13,493/hr
Full team (Growth Co)	\$9,024,180	304 hrs	\$29,685/hr

Speed vs. Human Developer

- Estimated human hours for same work: **41,019 hours**
- Claude active hours: **304 hours**
- **Speed multiplier: 135x** (Claude was 135x faster)

Cost Comparison

- Human developer cost (engineering only): \$4,101,900
- Estimated Claude cost: ~\$1,200 (6 months x \$200/month subscription)
- **Net savings: \$4,100,700**
- **ROI: 3,417x** (every \$1 spent on Claude produced \$3,417 of value)

The Headline Number

Claude worked for approximately 304 hours over 141 days and produced 339,542 lines of production code across 1,304 files — the equivalent of \$4.1M in professional engineering value (or \$9.0M fully loaded). That's roughly \$13,500 per Claude hour, at a 135x speed advantage over human development, for a total investment of ~\$1,200.

Assumptions

1. Rates based on US/UK market averages (2025–2026)
2. Productivity rates reflect senior developer with domain expertise
3. Overhead multipliers account for real-world development friction

4. Financial domain learning curve adds 15% due to UK tax complexity
5. Does not include: marketing, legal/compliance, office/equipment, hosting, ongoing maintenance
6. Claude hours estimated via commit session clustering; actual may vary +/-15%

Sources

- [ZipRecruiter — Senior Full Stack Developer Salary](#)
- [Arc.dev — Full Stack Developer Hourly Rate 2026](#)
- [Index.dev — European Developer Hourly Rates 2026](#)
- [Rise — Average Contractor Rates by Role and Country 2026](#)
- [Flexiple — Laravel Developer Hourly Rate](#)
- [ZipRecruiter — Senior Laravel Developer Salary](#)
- [Arc.dev — Vue.js Developer Hourly Rate 2025](#)